BONUS · EXAM MAP

The RBT Exam at a Glance

Where the points are: study time should follow these weights.

Behavior Acquisition — 25%

19 scored questions · Study cards 29–53

Behavior Reduction — 19%

14 scored questions · Study cards 54–72

Data Collection & Graphing — 17%

13 scored questions · Study cards 01–17

Ethics — 15%

11 scored questions · Study cards 86–100

Documentation & Reporting — 13%

10 scored questions · Study cards 73–85

Behavior Assessment — 11%

8 scored questions · Study cards 18–28

How the exam works

85 multiple-choice questions in 90 minutes. 75 are scored and 10 are unscored pilot questions mixed in, so answer every question as if it counts. Questions are mostly short scenarios: identify what the RBT should do or what a procedure is called. The two biggest areas, Behavior Acquisition and Behavior Reduction, are 44% of the exam together.

Study aid based on the public RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.). Not affiliated with or endorsed by the BACB.

BONUS · STUDY PLAN

Your Study Plan

Pick the plan that matches the time until your exam.

4-week plan

Week 1

Data Collection (cards 01–17) + Behavior Assessment (18–28). Daily: 4–5 cards, then cover the page and explain the "Tell the difference" box out loud.

Week 2

Behavior Acquisition (29–53), the biggest area. Daily: 4 cards. Make a list of verbal operants and schedules and quiz yourself.

Week 3

Behavior Reduction (54–72) + Documentation (73–85). Daily: 4–5 cards. Focus on DRA/DRO/DRI/DRL and extinction.

Week 4

Ethics (86–100) in days 22–23. Day 24: **Practice Exam 1**. Days 25–26: review missed areas. Day 27: **Practice Exam 2**. Day 28: read every "Exam traps" box.

2-week plan (exam is close)

Days 1–3

Cards 01–28 (Data + Assessment).

Days 4–7

Cards 29–53 (Acquisition).

Days 8–10

Cards 54–85 (Reduction + Documentation).

Day 11

Cards 86–100 (Ethics).

Day 12

Practice Exam 1 + review mistakes.

Day 13

Practice Exam 2 + review mistakes.

Day 14

Light review: all "Exam traps" boxes. Sleep well.

Study tips that work

• Short daily sessions beat one long session. • After each card, close it and explain it in your own words. • Test yourself more than you re-read. • Keep a list of every question you miss and why. • On exam day, read the last line of the question first.

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BONUS · ETHICS CHEAT SHEET

RBT Ethics on One Page

The rules behind every ethics question (cards 86–100).



Client welfare first
Every decision should protect the client's safety, dignity and best interest.



Stay in your role
Implement plans; don't design, change or interpret treatment. That's the BCBA.



Practice under supervision
Ongoing supervision is required. Ask for direction when unsure.



Work within your competence
Only procedures you've been trained on. Ask for training first.



Protect confidentiality
Share only with authorized people, only what's needed. Never on social media.

Avoid multiple relationships
No babysitting, business, dating or friendships with clients or families.



Handle gifts carefully
Decline valuable gifts and cash; follow the code and agency policy; tell your supervisor.



Be honest in data, notes and billing
Record what really happened. Never falsify, backdate or bill canceled sessions.

Represent your credential accurately
"Registered Behavior Technician". Never claim to be a behavior analyst.



Report what must be reported
Mandated reporting by law; self-report required events to the BACB.



Respect every family
Cultural responsiveness, non-discrimination and client dignity.

Exam rule of thumb: the best answer protects the client, stays within the RBT role and involves the supervisor. Read the full, current RBT Ethics Code at bacb.com.

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BONUS · VISUAL GLOSSARY

Key Terms

Quick definitions with the card where each term is explained.

ABC data card 13, 25
Record of antecedent, behavior and consequence.

Abolishing operation (AO) card 53
Decreases the value of a reinforcer (e.g., satiation).

Antecedent card 25
What happens right before a behavior.

Antecedent intervention card 55
Changing conditions before behavior to prevent it.

Automatic reinforcement card 24, 71
Reinforcement produced by the behavior itself.

Backward chaining card 48
Teach the last step first; adult does the earlier steps.

Baseline card 16
Data collected before intervention begins.

BIP card 54
Behavior intervention plan written by the BCBA.

Conditioned reinforcer card 31
Becomes a reinforcer through pairing (praise, tokens).

Continuous measurement card 09
Records every instance (frequency, duration, latency, IRT).

Continuous reinforcement card 32
Every correct response is reinforced; for new skills.

Data path card 14
Line connecting data points in the same phase.

Discrete trial training card 35
Structured teaching: SD → response → consequence → ITI.

Discrimination training card 50
Reinforce responses to the SD, not to the S-delta.

DRA card 61
Reinforce an appropriate alternative behavior.

DRI card 63
Reinforce a behavior incompatible with the problem behavior.

DRL card 64
Reinforce lower rates of a behavior.

DRO card 62
Reinforce the absence of the behavior for an interval.

Duration card 03
How long a behavior lasts, from onset to offset.

Echoic card 39
Repeating what someone just said.

Establishing operation (EO) card 53
Increases the value of a reinforcer (e.g., deprivation).

Extinction card 58
Withholding the reinforcer that maintained a behavior.

Extinction burst card 59
Temporary increase in behavior when extinction begins.

FCT card 65
Teaching communication that gets the same reinforcer as problem behavior.

FBA card 23
Process to identify the function of a behavior.

Fixed interval (FI) card 33
First response after a set time is reinforced.

Fixed ratio (FR) card 33
Reinforcement after a set number of responses.

Forward chaining card 48
Teach the first step first, then add steps.

Frequency card 02
Number of times a behavior occurs.

Function card 24
Why a behavior happens: attention, escape, tangible, automatic.

Generalization card 51
Skill occurs with new people, settings or materials.

High-p request sequence card 57
Easy requests before a harder one (momentum).

Intermittent reinforcement card 32
Only some responses are reinforced; for maintenance.

Intraverbal card 40
Verbal response to others' words, not matching them.

IRT card 05
Time from the end of one response to the start of the next.

Latency card 04
Time from a cue to the start of the response.

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BONUS · VISUAL GLOSSARY

Key Terms

Quick definitions with the card where each term is explained.

Listener responding card 41
Acting on someone's words (pointing, following directions).

Maintenance card 52
Skill continues over time after teaching ends.

Mand card 37
A request, controlled by motivation.

Momentary time sampling card 08
Record only at the moment the interval ends.

MSWO card 22
Choose from an array; chosen item is not replaced.

NCR card 56
Reinforcer delivered on a time schedule, not after behavior.

Negative punishment card 66
Remove something → behavior decreases.

Negative reinforcement card 29
Remove something → behavior increases.

Operational definition card 01
Observable, measurable description of behavior.

Paired stimulus card 21
Two items per trial; client picks one.

Partial interval card 07
Score if behavior occurs at any time in the interval.

Permanent product card 10
Measure the lasting result of a behavior.

Phase change line card 16
Vertical line marking a change in condition.

Positive punishment card 66
Add something → behavior decreases.

Positive reinforcement card 29
Add something → behavior increases.

Prompt card 42
Extra help to evoke the correct response.

Prompt dependence card 45
Waiting for help even when able to respond.

Rate card 02
Count divided by time observed.

Response cost card 67
Removal of a set amount of reinforcer (e.g., tokens).

S-delta (SΔ) card 50
Stimulus signaling reinforcement is not available.

SD card 50
Stimulus signaling reinforcement is available for a response.

Shaping card 46
Reinforcing successive approximations of a target behavior.

Spontaneous recovery card 60
Extinguished behavior briefly reappears later.

Stimulus control card 50
Responding differs in the presence of SD vs S-delta.

Tact card 38
Labeling something in the environment.

Task analysis card 47
A complex skill broken into ordered steps.

Time-out card 68
Brief loss of access to reinforcement.

Token economy card 34
Tokens earned and exchanged for backup reinforcers.

Total task chaining card 49
All steps taught every time, prompting as needed.

Trend card 15
Direction of the data over time.

Unconditioned reinforcer card 31
Works without learning (food, water, warmth).

Variability card 15
How much data points bounce around.

Variable interval (VI) card 33
First response after an average time is reinforced.

Variable ratio (VR) card 33
Reinforcement after an average number of responses.

Whole interval card 06
Score only if behavior lasts the entire interval.

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